

The real differentiator came in the stress test. When we ran the CPU throttling test on both phones, Realme remained stable, maintaining high performance throughout, while the iQOO Neo 10 showed noticeable thermal throttling after 15 minutes under load. However, iQOO has fixed these performance dips now with an update, but a week back, when we were testing this phone, Realme performed better.

Display: Bright numbers

When it comes to display specs, both of these phones pack a 6.78-inch 1.5K AMOLED display with a 120Hz refresh rate. Furthermore, iQOO claims 144Hz during gaming, but during our BGMI test, both maxed out at 102FPS.

We also tested them for colour accuracy with the Calman test, and in that space, Realme had a lead with a Delta E of just 0.7, which is near perfect. iQOO isn't far behind but loses out on some details.

Brightness is where iQOO flexes hard, peaking at a jaw-dropping 3340 nits compared to Realme's under-2000 nit output. However, Realme still appears brighter indoors, while iQOO clearly wins in outdoor visibility. Overall, Realme's display feels more balanced.

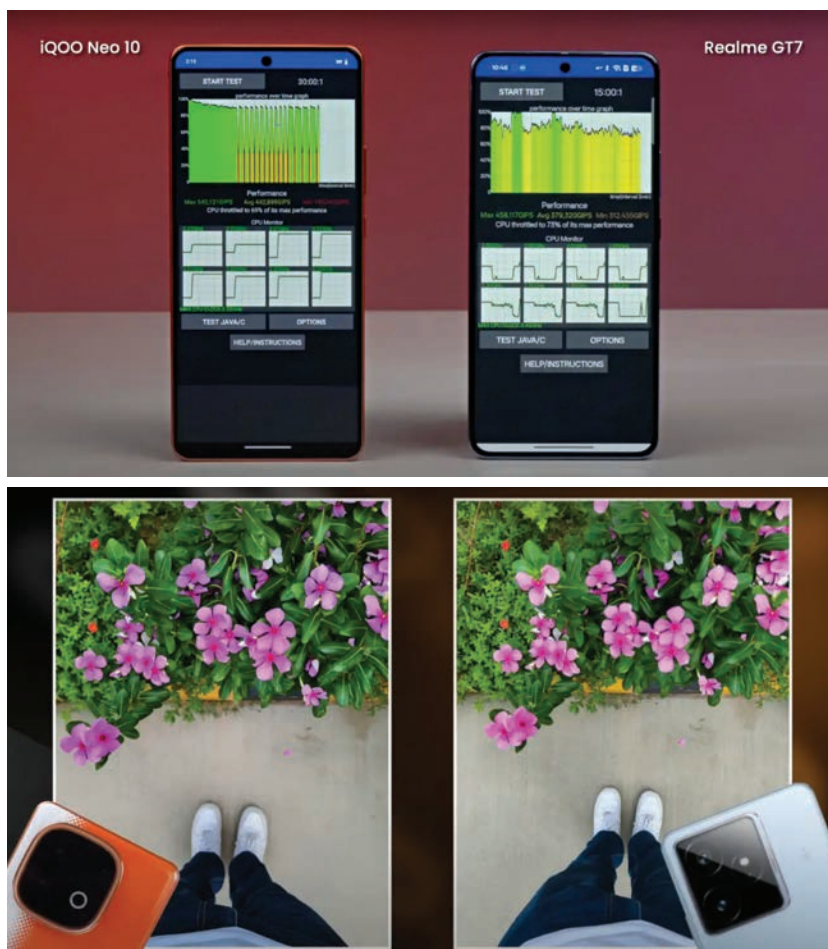
Battery and charging: Close call

Both phones feature massive 7000mAh batteries and 120W fast charging. In real-world tests, iQOO went from 0 to 100% in 40 minutes and delivered over 22 hours in PCMark's battery benchmark.

The Realme GT 7 took 42 minutes and came in just under 21 hours. So the iQOO Neo 10 took the trophy in this round. In real-world usage, both of these smartphones will last you for about 2 days on moderate use.

iQOO Neo 10 vs Realme GT 7: Cameras

Realme GT 7 has a triple camera setup that includes a telephoto lens, and on the iQOO Neo 10, you only get a main camera and an ultrawide lens.



The cameras turned out as I expected them to be. The Realme takes the lead when it comes to photography. The main camera of the Realme clicks crisp and natural pictures, whereas the iQOO's pictures are slightly on the brighter side, and they look vibrant if you're into that.

The sensor of the telephoto lens also gives the Realme an edge, as you can see how crisp the Realme's shot is in comparison to iQOO.

But, iQOO reclaims itself when it comes to low-light photography with its AI upscaling. The final shots are better on the iQOO Neo 10, and even the light management is better with it.

Portraits are a mixed bag, while Realme takes more natural-looking shots, the iQOO takes brighter shots, but the smoothening on the skin is extremely visible. The edge detection is just decent on both phones.

Final verdict: Is price the decider?

The iQOO Neo 10 gives you raw performance at a killer price. For over ₹10,000 less, it keeps pace with Realme on most fronts. That alone makes it a tempting pick.

But the Realme GT 7 justifies its premium with better cameras, smoother sustained performance, superior display accuracy, and a more complete package overall.

So, if you want maximum value and gaming chops, pick iQOO. If you want balance, polish, and better photography, Realme is worth the extra. **d**

